

● NOW RECRUITING · FOUNGING COHORT

Research Internship

Summer 2026

A two-month, fully remote research program for students headed into high finance — learn how AI is really reshaping the industry by researching it yourself.

AT A GLANCE

COHORT

6–10 students

DURATION

2 months · 8 weeks

FORMAT

Fully remote

COMMITMENT

8–10 hrs / week

The future of finance learns AI first.

Independent · student-founded · not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund.

● WHY JOIN

Get in early on the question every firm is asking.

Learn it before your peers

Walk into VC, PE, banking, or wealth management already fluent in how AI is actually used there.

Real research, not busywork

You own a focus and produce work that gets published — no coffee runs.

Shape it from day one

As founding-cohort members, you help set the research agenda.

Work with the founder

A small cohort means close mentorship and weekly time to share findings.

● WHAT YOU'LL WORK ON

One question: how is AI really used across finance?

You'll choose and own a focus inside it — then research, write, and present what you find.

01

Efficient uses

Where AI genuinely creates an edge — in research, diligence, and dealmaking.

02

Overhyped bets

Where money and attention chase AI that doesn't hold up to scrutiny.

03

Real workflows

How investors and bankers actually use AI day to day, behind the headlines.

EACH WEEK YOU PRODUCE

A 300-word research brief · a LinkedIn post excerpt · a research deck you present to the cohort — using AI tools to gather, compile, and visualize what you find.

● RESEARCH TRACKS

Eight tracks — choose one to own.

Every track is grounded in primary research: you'll reach out to and learn from professionals and interns at the firms you study.

01 Deal sourcing & origination
Is AI finding better deals — or just more noise?

02 Due diligence & document review
Where data-room AI saves hours vs. where it can't.

03 Financial modeling & analysis
What juniors actually use vs. where it breaks.

04 Investment & market research
Differentiated insight, or commoditized?

05 Memo, CIM & pitch generation
First-draft speed vs. narrative and credibility.

06 Wealth management & client work
Adoption vs. fiduciary and trust limits.

07 Risk, compliance & back office
Where AI quietly works best — and least hyped.

08 The tooling map
Catalog the real tools: sticky vs. vaporware.

● HOW WE RESEARCH

We don't recycle hot takes. We go to the source.

Three tiers of evidence — original research first; social signals only as leads we verify.

1 Talk to the people doing the work

Interviews with analysts, associates, and partners across banking, PE, venture, and wealth — plus surveys of practitioners and interns, and hands-on testing of the tools firms actually use.

2 Ground every claim in real data

Industry research (McKinsey, BCG, the Evident AI Index), earnings calls, and company filings — sourced and cited, not rumor.

3 Watch where the conversation lives

LinkedIn, Reddit, X, and practitioner newsletters surface what to investigate next — leads we verify at the source before publishing.

● WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

Three things you can't get from a classroom.

How AI is reshaping finance

A grounded, hype-free view of where AI creates an edge across VC, PE, banking, and wealth — and where it doesn't.

How to run research solo

Scope a question, gather evidence, and produce sharp, defensible findings on your own.

How to build with AI tools

Use AI to research, compile, and generate illustrative, presentation-ready work you can stand behind.

You leave with a portfolio of published briefs and a research deck — proof you can think, research, and communicate.

● THE TWO-MONTH STRUCTURE

From picking a focus to presenting real research.

1 Week 1 · Onboard & Scope

Get the tools and the research approach. Explore the landscape and choose the focus area you'll own.

2 Weeks 2–6 · Research & Publish

The weekly rhythm: research your question and ship a brief, a LinkedIn excerpt, and a deck you present at the all-hands.

3 Weeks 7–8 · Synthesize & Present

Pull it together into a final research deck and a publishable piece for the Collective, presented to the cohort.

● THE WEEKLY RHYTHM & WHAT WE EXPECT

A steady cadence — and what it takes.

What you'll be responsible for

- A 300-word research brief, every week
- A weekly LinkedIn post excerpt
- A research deck you present at the all-hands
- Reaching out to and learning from professionals and interns at the firms you study

Who we're looking for

- Undergrads headed for VC, PE, investment banking, or wealth management
- Genuinely curious about AI — not just the hype
- Able to work independently and manage ~8–10 hrs/week
- Any year, any major. Drive over resume.

● HOW TO APPLY

Founding-cohort applications open June 23.

Apply on our site and tell us what about AI in finance you're itching to dig into. We read every application.

APPLICATIONS OPEN

Tuesday, June 23

APPLICATIONS CLOSE

Sunday, June 28

FOUNDING COHORT STARTS

July 1

THE HONEST NOTICE

This is an unpaid internship with an independent, student-founded group. Applied Intelligence Collective is not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund, and participation does not imply or guarantee any offer of employment.